

If you are used to troubleshooting, you are most likely following something similar in your head already. Once you begin to think in terms of the various sub-systems, the chances of you not finding your problem are very low. Over time, and with experience, you would be doing this naturally and automatically. Of course on paper it looks terribly boring and to tell you the truth, it is! But, it is a good strategy to use a methodical approach in troubleshooting rather than dive straight in, start poking around, pressing keys and buttons blindly and then regretting it later.

After trying everything and you are at your wits end with no solution in sight, it is time to take a step back and forget about it for a while—attack the problem after some time with a fresh mind. You could also post a message in the relevant *Digit* forum sub-section (www.thinkdigit.com/forum), the members are pretty helpful and quite experienced. Chances are someone else has faced the same problem and you should be able to get an answer quickly.

1.2 Don't Be Careless

When working with hardware, the first thing is to ground yourself properly. Whenever you are tinkering under the hood, have an anti-static wrist strap hooked up. If you don't have one, stop what you are doing and go buy one now! Never, ever, work without protecting your delicate electronic components from static. A tiny shot of static can fry your CPU, RAM and even the motherboard.

Computer components have highly complex and delicate electronics. When working with an exposed and live motherboard don't try to take shortcuts, keep the area clear of other electricity conductors, an accidental short can just as well fry your PC components. The same goes for leaving components lying around on the floor, or on the edge of the shelf—you could accidentally step on or drop them. Also take care to not drop things onto the motherboard, bend any components or touch anything you shouldn't.